

Brief Article

The Author

May 22, 2026

Driving idea

About 12 years ago I had a small idea. Like when you're tacking a sailboat from A to B, it seemed to me like I could take each tack right and tack left and consider them as strips perpendicular to A-B, flip every other strip end to end, in which case the path becomes a straight line. Then maybe use combinatorial maps, and optimize it over the number of strips. Never followed up on it, since I couldn't really formalize the concept.

```
int main() {  
    printf("hello, world");  
    return 0;  
}
```